

THE TRAGEDY AT WALTHAMSTOW.

William Gouldstone, the blacksmith who was arrested last night in connection with the Walthamstow tragedy, was examined at the Stratford petty sessions this morning on a charge of murdering his three children, Charles, aged three and a half years; Herbert, aged two and a half years; and Frederick, aged sixteen months, by drowning them [in a cistern; and on the further charge of murdering his two infant children, aged seven days, by striking them on the head with a hammer. Ada Hamilton, a monthly nurse said she had been attending the prisoner's wife since the 1st of August, when she was confined of twins, and she had lived in the house as a lodger for the last ten weeks. Last evening, between five and six o'clock, while she was washing the two babies in Mrs. Gouldstone's bedroom, she heard the prisoner come in and go to the kitchen where the two eldest children were playing. A little later, while prisoner was in his wife's room, witness heard Mrs. Gouldstone screaming "Murder," and "Good God! he is murdering my children," and when witness got into the room he remarked "I have killed my children; I am a happy man now." The two babies by the wife's side were bleeding at the mouth; and on going into the kitchen she found the three other children lying in a row on the floor all dead. They had been in some water. The prisoner seemed fond of his children, but he appeared strange after the twins were born.

The prisoner was remanded till Saturday.